

How to Stop Saying Sorry

When You Don't Need To

1. Need someone's time?

- ❌ "Sorry to bother you."
- ✅ "Do you have a moment?"

2. Asking a question?

- ❌ "Sorry, this might be a dumb question."
- ✅ "I'd love some clarity on this."

3. Taking up space in a room?

- ❌ "Sorry, just trying to get through."
- ✅ "Excuse me."

4. Speaking up in a meeting?

- ❌ "Sorry, can I add something?"
- ✅ "I have something to add."

5. Pointing out a mistake?

- ❌ "Sorry, but I think this is wrong."
- ✅ "I noticed something - let's take a look."

6. Following up?

- ❌ "Sorry to follow up again."
- ✅ "Just checking in - any updates?"

7. Need more time?

- ❌ "Sorry, I need a few more minutes."
- ✅ "I'll have this ready shortly."

8. Declining a request?

- ❌ "Sorry, I can't do that."
- ✅ "I appreciate it, but I have to pass."

9. Giving feedback?

- ❌ "Sorry, can I make a suggestion?"
- ✅ "Here's an idea to consider."

10. Expressing disagreement?

- ❌ "Sorry, but I don't see it that way."
- ✅ "I see it differently - here's why."

11. Setting a boundary?

- ❌ "Sorry, I can't make it."
- ✅ "I'm unavailable, but let's connect later."

12. Clarifying something?

- ❌ "Sorry, I meant to say..."
- ✅ "To clarify..."

13. Taking a break?

- ❌ "Sorry, I just need a minute."
- ✅ "I'll be stepping away for a moment."

14. Need help?

- ❌ "Sorry, but could you help me?"
- ✅ "Could you support me with this?"

15. Expressing frustration?

- ❌ "Sorry, but this is really frustrating."
- ✅ "This is frustrating - let's figure it out."

16. Changing plans?

- ❌ "Sorry, I have to reschedule."
- ✅ "I need to reschedule - what other time works?"

17. Correcting yourself?

- ❌ "Sorry, what I meant was..."
- ✅ "Let me rephrase that..."

18. Arriving late?

- ❌ "Sorry I'm late."
- ✅ "Thanks for waiting."

19. Handling a misunderstanding?

- ❌ "Sorry if that was unclear."
- ✅ "Let me clarify what I meant."

20. Celebrating your success?

-  "Sorry, I don't want to brag."
-  "I'm proud of this achievement."

21. For existing

-  "Sorry for being a bother."
 -  "Thank you for your time."
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Own your words.

Own your space.

No apology needed.